

PAUL J. ROMEO

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SUMMARY

Security-focused IT professional who handles all security and IT for a 4-person family business. Runs phishing/BEC investigations from detection through takedown reports to registrars and hosts; administers ESET EDR, UniFi networking and Protect surveillance, and TrueNAS storage. B.S. in Cybersecurity & Information Assurance (WGU, August 2026) backed by nine industry certifications including Security+, CySA+, PenTest+, and ISC2 SSCP.

CORE SKILLS

Security Operations: EDR Administration (ESET EDR / Cloud Protect) | Incident Response | Phishing & BEC Investigation | Attacker-Infrastructure Takedowns | Log Analysis | Wazuh SIEM | Duo MFA | Vulnerability Management | Endpoint Hardening | Patch Management

Network & Infrastructure: UniFi Networking | VLANs & Segmentation | TCP/IP, DNS, Wi-Fi | TrueNAS / SMB Storage | Backup & Disaster Recovery | Windows

Automation & Tools: Python | PowerShell | Bash | Git | GitHub Actions CI/CD

Business Platforms: BigCommerce | Amazon FBA | eBay | POS Integration

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA PenTest+ (PT0-003) — ID e3a26d1b0a1944db8e569cfa0ce20432 (Apr 2026 - Apr 2029)
- CompTIA CySA+ — ID RWEXWLLS9NRE5JE2 (Aug 2025 - Aug 2028)
- ISC2 SSCP — ID 1123939 (Jul 2025)
- CompTIA Project+ — ID K1MYZLGS02V415QJ (Jul 2025)
- LPI Linux Essentials — ID LPI000661841 (Aug 2025)
- CompTIA Security+ — ID 2SY3TK06GJ44Q4WQ (Jul 2024 - Jul 2027)
- CompTIA Network+ — ID N0BPXTXZFFV4QM3T (Jun 2024 - Jun 2027)
- CompTIA A+ — ID G33N7H5ZJERE1F5W (Jun 2024 - Jun 2027)
- ITIL 4 Foundation — ID GR671719240PR (Dec 2024 - Dec 2027)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT & Security Administrator — Belmont Leather Company

Clifton, NJ | 2021 - Present

- Sole IT and security person at a 4-person family business: workstations, printers, network devices, storage, and backups.
- Administer ESET EDR and ESET Cloud Protect across ~15 endpoints; built automated threat alerting, weekly CVE exposure reviews, and endpoint update management.
- Reimage, rebuild, and harden endpoints; restore systems and files from TrueNAS backups after incidents.
- Investigate phishing and BEC attempts — triage indicators of compromise (IOCs), then file registrar/host/abuse-desk takedowns against attacker infrastructure (ClickFix malware lures, BEC impersonation attempts, SSA/ScreenConnect lures, and brand-impersonation waves).
- Set up the company's infrastructure: a UniFi network with VLAN segmentation, a 10-camera UniFi Protect surveillance system, and TrueNAS storage with SMB shares and scheduled cloud backup.
- Handle the company's e-commerce platform alongside IT (BigCommerce + POS integration).

Theater Technician (Part-time) — Rowan University

2018 - 2020

- Operated and maintained lighting, sound, and life-safety systems across 20+ live productions, troubleshooting failures under show-time pressure.
- Coordinated setup and teardown with student and faculty crews for rehearsals, performances, and campus events.

IT Help Desk Technician & Media Services Specialist — Southern New Hampshire University

2016 - 2018

- Delivered Tier 1/2 support to 200+ users: malware removal, security policy enforcement, hardware/software triage, and account administration.
- Maintained classroom and AV technology across campus, supporting lectures, media playback, and hybrid events.

PROJECTS

OSINT Fraud Network Investigation — Independent

September 2026

- Identified a network of 14 fraudulent websites and 8 payment processors impersonating real small businesses.
- Traced the operation to a single threat actor using WHOIS data, Burp Suite, DNS analysis, and a shared admin handle found in page source.
- Reported the full network to registrars, the FTC (confirmed, control on file), and Google Ads/Maps with evidence; corrections filed and takedowns in progress. Public case file: fakeboot.paulromeo.net.

EDUCATION

B.S. Cybersecurity & Information Assurance — Western Governors University, August 2026